

ZERENE

SEO & GEO Alignment Brief

Closing the workflow gaps between SEO, content, and the GEO/AIO strategy

1. Diagnosis: This Is a Workflow Gap, Not a Performance Gap

The feedback from the SEO expert is accurate and reflects four separate, fixable breakdowns — not underperformance on their part:

- Access — SEO expert can only work on blog technical SEO; product and collection pages are out of reach.
- Handoff — Keywords are shared with the content writer but there is no checkpoint forcing their use before a blog goes live (confirmed: the latest published blog used none of the provided keywords).
- Topic sourcing — Blog topics are assigned by the client before anyone checks keyword demand or fit with the Zerene ICP, so some topics have no real search volume to target and others target the wrong audience.
- Measurement window — Impact was reported on a ~1 month window (16 Jul to 18 Aug), shorter than Google's typical 15 to 25 day crawl/reindex cycle after changes go live, making early conclusions unreliable.

Each is addressed below with a specific fix and an owner.

2. Fix: Access & Ownership

Page type	Current access	Needed	Owner
Blog posts	Full technical SEO access	No change	SEO expert
Product pages	No access	Grant access, or assign explicitly to a named owner	To be assigned
Collection pages	No access	Grant access, or assign explicitly to a named owner	To be assigned
FAQ page	Unclear / in progress	Confirm ownership once rebuilt (see Content Framework)	Writer + SEO jointly

Until product and collection pages have a named owner with access, no SEO work can happen there — this should be resolved before the next reporting cycle, since these are the highest commercial-intent pages on the site.

3. Fix: Keyword-to-Content Handoff Workflow

Replace the current informal handoff with a locked sequence. No blog moves to publish without step 4 signed off.

1. SEO expert proposes 3 to 5 target keywords per topic, tagged with search volume and intent (Premium/B2B vs. Consumer/Budget, per the Content Framework).
2. Topic and keywords are checked against the GEO Content Framework's ICP and intent filter before approval — reject or revise topics that fail either check.
3. Approved keywords go into the content brief the writer works from, not a separate message or thread.
4. Before publishing, the writer confirms in the brief which keywords were used and where (title, H1, intro, at least one subheading).
5. SEO expert signs off on the draft before it publishes, checking keyword placement against the brief.

This closes the exact gap that caused the latest blog to ship with none of the provided keywords used.

4. Fix: Blog Topic Filter

Before a topic is assigned to the writer, it must pass both checks below. If either fails, the topic is revised or dropped, regardless of who originally proposed it.

Check	Question	Fail condition
Keyword demand	Does this topic have real, targetable search volume (SEO) or AI prompt volume (GEO)?	No meaningful volume in either channel
ICP / intent fit	Does this topic match Premium/B2B intent: corporate, executive, gifting, hospitality, wellness, not Consumer/Budget?	Topic reads as generic consumer aromatherapy or room fragrance content

5. Fix: Extend Scope to Product & Collection Pages

Blog SEO alone cannot move overall visibility while the commercial pages are untouched — this applies to both traditional SEO and GEO/AI visibility, since product pages are what AI engines cite for "where to buy" and "which brand" style prompts, not blog posts.

- Prioritize the product pages tied to the highest-value GEO prompt gaps already identified (e.g. the luxurious aromatherapy room sprays / corporate scenting prompt cluster).
- Apply the same direct-answer, fact-dense formatting from the Content Framework to product descriptions, not just blog content.
- Collection pages should carry the Parent-Anchor keywords (high-volume commercial terms) since they are the natural landing point for that intent.

6. Fix: Realistic Measurement Cadence

Set expectations before the next report goes out, so results are not judged against an unrealistic timeline:

- Allow 15 to 25 days after any change publishes before expecting any crawl or index movement — this is a Google mechanic, not a delay on the SEO expert's side.
- Report on a rolling basis, but treat any single reporting window under 6 to 8 weeks as directional only, not conclusive.
- Tie each reporting cycle to what was actually shipped that cycle (blog technical SEO vs. product page work vs. new content) so impact can be attributed correctly instead of judged in aggregate.

7. Action Items

Action	Owner	Status
Grant SEO expert (or assign named owner) access to product & collection pages	Zerene / site admin	Open
Adopt the keyword-to-content handoff workflow (Section 3) starting next blog	SEO expert + writer	Open
Apply topic filter (Section 4) to all pending and future blog topics	Whoever assigns topics	Open
Share Content Framework doc with SEO expert	Slicky	Done

Action	Owner	Status
Reset reporting cadence to 6 to 8 week evaluation windows	Slicky / client	Open

Zerene SEO & GEO Alignment Brief. Pairs with the GEO/AIO Content Framework. Share both with the SEO expert and content writer.